Muncie Policy Memo

# Civic Meeting Report

# 10/20/2026 MCS Board Meeting

| Meeting Metadata | Details |
|---|---|
| **Video Recording** | https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0sC5cL_kHdM |
| **Publication Date** | 2026-10-20 00:00:00 |
| **Target Category** | mcs |

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# Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Education

## 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Williams called the regular meeting of the Muncie Community Schools (MCS) Board of Education to order on a "beautiful, beautiful October afternoon" 00:08:14.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Dr. O'Neal 00:08:20, Miss Barnes Griffin 00:08:22, Mr. Low 00:08:36, Mr. Irving 00:08:38, and Dr. Washburn (arrived late due to a traffic detour near Walnut and Huntington Well) 00:13:22.
  - **Absent:** Mr. Heater (out of town) 00:08:40.
  - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams 00:13:47.

## 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence 00:06:22 followed by the Pledge of Allegiance 00:07:46 led by student representatives from the student council and "big brother" understudy program introduced by Mr. Amler 00:06:45.

- **Superintendent's Report (00:08:46):** Dr. Reynolds reported on athletic successes, noting back-to-back conference championships for the girls volleyball team and strong performances by the boys football team heading into sectionals [00:08:51–00:10:07]. He also announced that official October 1 student enrollment counts are up from the spring count and above budget projections [00:10:13–00:10:30], recruitment for CEO student advisory teams is underway 00:10:58, and the business office received a clean, error-free outside audit 00:11:42.

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## 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

### 00:13:36 Westview Elementary School Presentation & Staff Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Principal Mr. Amler, Assistant Principal Miss Davis, and Master Coach Kelly Agnu [00:14:26–00:14:57].
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - **English Language Learners (ELL):** ELL students comprise 12.5% (roughly 1 in 8 students) at Westview Elementary 00:15:19. Using Title I funding via Dr. Bell, staff partnered with national ELL expert Dr. Carol Salva (Ella's Consulting) for professional development focusing on explicit vocabulary instruction and academic background knowledge [00:16:14–00:19:11].
  - **School Safety:** Collaborating with the Muncie Police Department (Chief Sloan) and City Council members (Selvi and Powell), Westview established designated drop-off/pickup lanes, temporary speed bumps, a "speed table," and an ordinance banning parking on narrow side streets during arrival and dismissal [00:19:43–00:22:05]. Additional safety gear (high-visibility vests, stop signs, walkies, and a speed sensor) was secured via a Safe Routes to School grant and Ball State University leadership cadre partners [00:22:30–00:23:31].
  - **Suspension Reductions:** Assistant Principal Miss Davis reported that out-of-school suspension (OSS) incidents dropped by 61% (exceeding their 50% reduction goal, moving from 192 down to 75 incidents) [00:24:10–00:24:26]. Special education OSS incidents decreased by 20% (from 55 to 44) 00:24:30. Strategies include monthly positive behavior convocations, alternative consequences (lunch detentions, extended school day, office timeouts), check-in/checkout programs, lunch bunch counseling, and restorative group conversations [00:25:08–00:26:38].
  - **Early Literacy & I-READ Scores:** Master Coach Kelly Agnu highlighted strong growth in second and third-grade literacy supported by Ball State volunteers, retired teachers, and community churches [00:35:14–00:36:34]. Second-grade passing rates rose from 47% to 57%, and third-grade passing rates rose from 75.5% [00:36:36–00:37:44]. Strategies included doubled reading lab times, family I-READ

meetings, targeted data-driven small groups, and phonics surveys [00:38:02–00:41:55].

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal board vote required.

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### 00:49:00 Consent Agenda

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Mr. Clots 00:48:46.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed routine consent items, including new hires, and acknowledged donations to the Panther Pantry from the Cases and the "barn raisers" 00:49:07.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:49:34.

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### 00:49:41 Financial Report (September 2024/2025)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome (Chief Financial Officer) 00:49:43.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Derome reported that the official ADM student enrollment count is 4,860 students (13 higher than the February count and roughly 49 students above budget projections) [00:50:00–00:50:22]. September payroll headcount is down 38 employees compared to the previous year 00:51:20. The overall cash balance is just under $27 million, down over $13 million due to intentional spending on ongoing $19.9 million construction projects 00:51:48. An additional $6.8 million in bond proceeds was received on October 1st 00:52:19. The state loan balance stands at $4.2 million 00:52:26. Surpluses from enrollment will be considered for transfer into the Rainy Day fund at year-end 00:53:41.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:54:21.

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### 00:54:28 Medical Insurance Premiums & Carrier Renewal for 2027

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome 00:54:28 and consultants Brown & Brown (Richard Sutton and Ashley Snell) 00:54:54.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Administration recommended renewing medical, dental, and vision insurance with Anthem for 2027 with **zero percentage increase** in premiums for the fourth consecutive year [00:54:38–00:55:05]. This stability is attributed to lower-than-expected claims driven by a youthful workforce [00:55:51–00:56:07]. Open enrollment is scheduled for mid-November to mid-December 00:55:26.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:57:20.

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### 00:57:35 Bond Project: Permission to Advertise for Construction Manager as Constructor (CMc)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Derome 00:57:41.
- **Deliberation Summary:** With $6.8 million in new bond proceeds received for improvement projects slated for spring, summer, and fall of 2027, the district requested permission to issue a Request for Proposals (RFP) to solicit a Construction Manager as Constructor [00:57:46–00:58:15].
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:58:31.

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### 00:58:38 Policy Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim 00:58:39.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented three non-substantive policy updates vetted by legal counsel (Church Hill and Anthem), including updated language in fiscal management, personnel reporting (D300 policy), and library material removal request procedures (noting that Muncie Public Library holdings are exempt) [00:59:11–00:00:07].
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:00:23.

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## 4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public participation period 00:48:46.

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## 5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board members thanked Westview Elementary staff for their presentation and community partnerships 01:00:31.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote [00:1:0:42].

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